

The Lost Little Aurora

The snowlit fjords of the north run deep and blue between white mountains and dark green pines, dotted with cosy longhouses whose windows glow warm amber against the snow. Above them arches the Great World Tree, and on clear nights the sky dances with the colours of the aurora. The fjords are full of gentle wonders: a chattering squirrel who carries messages along the tree, two wise ravens, light spirits who dance in the dark, and frost giants who look fearsome but are mostly just cold and lonely. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a warm heart, thinks things through, and shares the fire. The grandest deeds are done by being clever and brave and kind, and even a giant met with a friendly word often turns out lonelier than it is fierce.



The Lost Little Aurora

Read aloud, or let an older child read it themselves. Pause at each question so the heroes can decide together. There are no wrong answers here, only braver ideas to try.

Before you begin

In the deep of winter the night grows long in the fjords, and the long night is meant to be the most beautiful time of all. High above the snow, the Aurora Spirits dance, and the whole sky ripples with teal and green and purple light. But on this particular evening, the sky stayed dark and still, as if it had forgotten how to shine.

There was a reason. The littlest Aurora Spirit had tumbled down out of the sky and fallen into the snowy Whispering Pines, and in her fall she had lost her colours. Now she huddled somewhere among the dark trees, far too shy and far too cold to glow, and without her the others would not dance.

Edda the Saga-Keeper called the two of you in from the cold, to the firelight of the Hearth Hall. "You have clever heads and kind hearts," she said, "and that is worth more on a night like this than any sword. Will you go into the pines and help the little aurora shine again?"

Into your hands she pressed three gifts: a little lantern to light your way, a ball of bright red yarn, and a honey bun still warm from the hearth. "Remember," she said, "up here we do not win by being the strongest. We win by being clever, brave, and kind."

What is your hero name? Which quality will you carry: Wit, Courage, or Heart?

Stop 1: The Dark Forest

You stepped out under the dark sky and into the Whispering Pines. The snow lay deep and soft and hushed, and the tall trees rose around you, still and quiet, with the wind carrying soft voices through their branches. Somewhere in all this stillness, one tiny aurora was hiding, shy and cold and no bigger than a pair of cupped hands.

She would be easy to miss. You would have to move gently and look with care.

How will you find her? You might walk softly and watch for the faintest glimmer of light, or follow small footprints pressed into the snow. Nori the Tomte, the red-capped hearth sprite, is somewhere nearby, and he loves to help. What do you try?

When you slowed right down and looked kindly into the shadows, you caught it: a soft, trembling glimmer behind a pine trunk. There she was, the littlest aurora, dim and shivering and very pleased to be found. "Hello," you whispered. "We came to help you." And she crept out to meet you.

Stop 2: The Three Colours

The little aurora was glad beyond words to be found, but try as she might, she could not make herself glow. "I lost my three colours when I fell," she said, and her voice was small. "Teal, and green, and purple. They slipped away into the world, and I cannot shine without them."

But the colours had not gone far at all. Each one was hiding somewhere close, in a thing that wore that very colour, if only you knew where to look.

Can you find all three of her colours? Where in this snowy place might teal be hiding? Where green? Where purple? Think of the icicles, the pines, and the wide evening sky.

You found her teal in the heart of a shining icicle, her green in the deep needles of a pine branch, and her purple high up where the twilight sky was turning dark. One colour at a time, you helped her draw each one back into herself, and one colour at a time, the little aurora

began to glow, soft and warm and brighter every moment.

Stop 3: The Climb to the Sky

She glowed now, gentle and lovely, but when she looked up at the great dark sky her light wavered. "It is so very high," she said. "What if I cannot reach it? What if I fall all over again?" Being found was one thing. Rising back up into the night was quite another, and she was afraid.

She did not need to be braver than her fear. She only needed a little courage borrowed from friends, and a hand to help her up.

How will you help her find her courage? You might climb the tallest pine beside her, cheer her on from below, or use the ball of red yarn to give her a gentle boost up into the air. What is your plan?

You climbed the tallest pine, branch by snowy branch, and tied the red yarn so she had something to hold. Then you counted together, one, two, three, and called out, "You can do it, we believe in you!" The little aurora drew a deep breath, let go of the topmost bough, and leapt up into the dark.

The Sky Dances Again

Up she went, and up, glowing brighter with every length she rose, until the other Aurora Spirits came swooping down to meet her, laughing and singing, "You came back! You came back to us!" They gathered her in among them as if she had never been gone.

And then the whole sky woke. Teal and green and purple spilled across the night and began to dance, ribbon over ribbon, swirling above the snowy fjord and the warm amber windows of the longhouses below. The long night was dark no longer, and all the fjords looked up in wonder.

High among the stars, Freya the Kind looked down and smiled. You had done it, and you had done it together: with your wit, with your courage, and above all with your heart. Well done, heroes of the Snowlit Fjords of the North.

The Story in Pictures



Two small heroes finding a tiny dim aurora spirit hiding among snowy pines at dusk, her light barely a glimmer.



A small aurora spirit gathering back her colours from an icicle, a pine and the twilight sky, two heroes pointing them out.



A small red-capped hearth sprite and two heroes cheering a glowing little aurora spirit as she gathers courage atop a tall snowy pine.



A glorious aurora dancing across a starry sky over a snowy fjord, a kind goddess smiling from the stars as two heroes watch in wonder.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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